

Motivation Letter

Dear Scholarship Selection Committee,

I am Sehar Fatima and I am here to state my keen interest in the Scotland Pakistan Scholarship, for my higher study in MPhil Biotechnology. Recently finished my BS in Biotechnology with a brilliant CGPA of 3.94 and got admitted at one of Pakistan's top agricultural education and research universities University of Agriculture Faisalabad (UAF). This scholarship would alleviate some of the financial obstacles and allow me to dedicate myself entirely to my academic studies and research and future professional aspirations.

I have always enjoyed science since the time of starting my studies. My FSc studies during the Covid-19 pandemic gave me a special interest in Biotechnology, the field that is helping to develop vaccine and solve health issues around the world. This is when I got to know about the contribution of biotechnologists during this crucial time and it sparked a fire in me to pursue Biotechnology as a field of study. I think Biotechnology is one of the most promising areas of modern science that not only can be used to improve human health but can help in the improvement of agricultural productivity, protection of the environment, and food security for the world. I selected this area because I wish to be a part of this discipline that can fix the problems and I wish to use my knowledge to solve the challenges of my country.

I have actively pursued excellence in my academic record through the commitment, consistency and dedication. I secured 1062/1100 marks in Matriculation and 1089/1100 marks in FSc. Throughout my BS Biotechnology program, I continued to study hard and always stayed in the top half of my class, earning a CGPA of 3.94. I was also actively engaged in learning activities to broaden my knowledge of biotechnology in addition to my academic studies. While I was still an undergrad, I went to a scientific conference and learned from established scientists and what new developments and trends were in biotechnology.

I also got a chance to do internship at District Headquarters Hospital, Lodhran where I got practical experience in using knowledge related to biotechnology in medical diagnosis and lab work. Through this experience I was able to develop an understanding of how theory relates to practice and the importance of accuracy, lab skills and scientific knowledge in real world

situations. Most importantly, these experiences reinforced my personal commitment to further studies and my ability to be a good researcher.

Now I am really happy to start my MPhil of Biotechnology at University of Agriculture Faisalabad. My post graduate studies will give me the chance to gain a more in depth understanding of science, further research skills and be able to participate in research projects that can support in addressing Pakistan's agricultural issues. But, it is high cost of post-graduate education that is a heavy burden on my family and they are not able to afford the complete cost of my higher studies. The Scotland Pakistan Scholarship would thus be an opportunity that would change my life. It would enable me to pursue my studies and research with more security of my finances and not be constantly worried about the expenses of education.

I am inspired particularly about this scholarship for the empowerment of women through education. I am from South Punjab and the girls from rural and less privileged backgrounds there have limited access to higher education due to financial and social pressures. To me, education isn't just about making a difference in my life, it's about making a difference in the lives of others. Earning a degree in biotechnology would allow me to share with young women in my community that they can do science, research, and a variety of other professions.

My long term objective is to pursue a career in Agricultural Biotechnology as I'm a country of agriculture. My ambition is to carry out research to develop solutions that can enhance the productivity of crops, quality of food and sustainability of agriculture. My special interest is to contribute for research work to the farmers of the rural and remote areas of Pakistan which can help their betterment. My use of biotechnology for addressing agricultural issues aims to foster food security, sustainable farming practices, and empowered, thriving agricultural communities.

After the completion of the MPhil, I wish to join research institutions/organizations engaged in agricultural research and development. I also wish to be a mentor and a motivator for young students, especially young girls from disadvantaged groups, and encourage them to pursue a career in science without opportunities and guidance. In my future trajectory, I wish to integrate research, education and community service for a more impactful and accessible biotechnology in Pakistan.

I think this is why I have the qualities to be a good candidate for the Scotland Pakistan Scholarship: due to my academic excellence, my passion and keen interest for Biotechnology, my practical experiences, and my clear understanding of how I will contribute to the development of Pakistan. My academic record reflects my ongoing striving to achieve difficult objectives and my conference attendance and internship experience has reinforced my ongoing fascination with the research and application of biotechnology to practical challenges. First and foremost, I have my purpose to learn advanced knowledge and skills, and apply them meaningfully in my country.

I would love to have the opportunity to use this scholarship to help me make a difference in research and professional work based on my academic abilities. I will be able to dedicate myself entirely to the MPhil program, improving my research skills and getting ready for contribution to the agricultural sector of Pakistan with financial support. I want to take the best of this and continue to give back in my community, with the goal of inspiring and encouraging other young women to go to college in the future.

I humbly request you to look into my application for Scholarship Selection Committee. It is not just about the financial aid, it is about my academic dreams, research potential and contribution to Pakistan's future, for me this is what this scholarship means. With this support, I am confident to finish my MPhil with utmost dedication and excellence, and will apply the knowledge gained from my education to make positive and lasting differences in my country.

Thank you for your consideration of my application.

Yours sincerely,

Sehar Fatima